

Topic 6: Criminal psychology – Why do people become criminals?

Subject content	What students need to learn:
6.1 Criminal psychology	6.1.1 Understand learning theories as an explanation of criminality, including strengths and weaknesses of each theory: • Operant Conditioning (Skinner, 1948), to include a. positive reinforcement b. negative reinforcement c. positive punishment d. negative punishment e. primary reinforcers f. secondary reinforcers • Social Learning Theory (Bandura, 1977), to include g. role models h. modelling i. identification j. observational learning k. vicarious reinforcement
	6.1.2 Understand biological explanations of criminality, including personality types (Eysenck, 1964), to include strengths and weaknesses of the theory: a. extraversion b. introversion c. neuroticism d. psychoticism
	6.1.3 Understand the effects of punishments on recidivism, including strengths and weaknesses of each punishment: a. prison b. community sentencing c. restorative justice

Subject content	What students need to learn:
	6.1.4 Understand two treatments to rehabilitate and reduce criminal and antisocial behaviour and increase pro-social behaviour, including strengths and weaknesses of each treatment: a. token economy programmes b. anger-management programmes